

2024 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE TRIAL EXAMINATION

English Advanced

Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

Stimulus Booklet

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This plates booklet MUST NOT be removed from the examination room

STUDENT NUMBER:

[illegible]

Text 2 – Poem

Fidgeting

To you, the silence in this stillness is to be endured
not experienced.
It scratches at every anxious bone that you own.

Do you find peace when you are alone?
Or do you claw your laptop open
chaining your eyes to your phone,
trade your thoughts for someone else's?
Too busy to impose
on yourself for a moment.

Be with yourself for a moment.
Be yourself for a moment.
Airplane mode everything but yourself for a moment.
Be, for a moment.
Don't speak for a moment.

For a moment embrace nothing but you in this present,
as the most important something to ever exist.

SOPHIA THAKUR

Text 3 – Online essay

Our tools shape our selves

For Bernard Stiegler, a visionary philosopher of our digital age, technics is the defining feature of human experience

It has become almost impossible to separate the effects of digital technologies from our everyday experiences. Reality is parsed through glowing screens, unending data feeds, biometric feedback loops, digital prostheses and expanding networks that link our virtual selves to satellite arrays in geostationary orbit. Wristwatches interpret our physical condition by counting steps and heartbeats. Phones track how we spend our time online, map the geographic location of the places we visit and record our histories in digital archives. Social media platforms forge alliances and create new political possibilities. And vast wireless networks – connecting satellites, drones and ‘smart’ weapons – determine how the wars of our era are being waged. Our experiences of the world are soaked with digital technologies.

But for the French philosopher Bernard Stiegler, one of the earliest and foremost theorists of our digital age, understanding the world requires us to move beyond the standard view of technology. Stiegler believed that technology is not just about the effects of digital tools and the ways that they impact our lives. It is not just about how devices are created and wielded by powerful organisations, nation-states or individuals. Our relationship with technology is about something deeper and more fundamental. It is about technics.

According to Stiegler, techniques – the making and use of technology, in the broadest sense – is what makes us human. Our unique way of existing in the world, as distinct from other species, is defined by the experiences and knowledge our tools make possible, whether that is a state-of-the-art computer, or a prehistoric flint axe used to clear a forest. In the late 20th century, Stiegler began applying this idea to new media technologies, such as television, which led to the development of a concept he called pharmacology – an idea that suggests we don’t simply ‘use’ our digital tools. Instead, they enter and pharmacologically change us, like medicinal drugs. While the internet presents us with a massive archive of formatted, readily accessible information, this exchange of unprecedented amounts of information enables the dissemination of an unprecedented amount of misinformation, conspiracy theories, and other harmful content. The digital is both a poison and a cure, as Derrida would say.

For Stiegler, there are inherent risks in thinking about technology in isolation. How we consume music, the paths we take to get from point A to point B, how we share ourselves with others, all of these aspects of daily life have been reshaped by new technologies and the humans that produce them. Yet we rarely stop to reflect on what this means for us. Stiegler believed this act of forgetting creates a deep crisis for all facets of human experience. By forgetting, we lose our all-important capacity to imagine alternative ways of living.

Text 3 continues on the next page

Text 3 (continues)

For Stiegler, techniques present opportunities for positive or negative relationships with tools. Technological development can destroy our sense of ourselves as rational, coherent subjects, leading to widespread suffering and destruction. But tools can also provide us with a new sense of what it means to be human, leading to new modes of expression and cultural practices.

Stiegler thinks technology defines who we are as humans, and through his theory of technics he urges us to rethink the history of philosophy, art and politics in order that we might better understand how our world has been shaped by technology. By acquiring this historical consciousness, he hopes that we will ultimately design better tools, using technology to improve our world in meaningful ways.

Technology, for better or worse, affects every aspect of our lives. Our very sense of who we are is shaped and reshaped by the tools we have at our disposal. The problem, for Stiegler, is that when we pay too much attention to our tools, rather than how they are developed and deployed, we fail to understand our reality. We become trapped, merely describing the technological world on its own terms and making it even harder to untangle the effects of digital technologies and our everyday experiences. By encouraging us to pay closer attention to this world-making capacity, with its potential to harm and heal, Stiegler is showing us what else is possible. There are other ways of living, of being, of evolving. It is technics, not technology, that will give the future its new face.

BRIAN NORTON

Adapted from *Aeon* online magazine

Text 4 – Nonfiction extract

Regret

Regret is a short, evocative and achingly beautiful word: an elegy* to lost possibilities even in its brief annunciation**, it is also a rarity and almost never heard except where the speaker insists that they have none. To admit regret is to understand we are fallible: that there are powers in the world beyond us; to admit regret is to lose control not only of a difficult past but of the very story we tell about our present and yet strangely, to admit sincere and abiding regret is one of our greatest but unspoken contemporary sins.

The rarity of honest regret may be due to our contemporary emphasis on the youthful perspective; it may be that a true regret is not the province of youth. It takes a hard-won maturity to experience the depths of regret in ways that do not overwhelm and debilitate us but to put us into a proper more generous relationship with the future. Except for brief senses of having missed a tide, having hurt another, having taken what is not ours, youth is not yet ready for the rich current of abiding regret that runs through and emboldens a mature life.

Sincere regret may in fact be permission to pay attention to the future, for sensing a new tide where we missed a previous one, for experiencing timelessness with a grandchild where we neglected a child of our own. To regret fully is to appreciate how high the stakes are in even the average human life. Fully experienced, regret turns our eyes, attentive and alert to a future possibly lived better than our past.

DAVID WHITE

Extract from

Consolations: The Solace, Nourishment and Underlying Meaning of Everyday Words

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- | | |
|-----------------|---|
| * elegy | <i>a poem of serious reflection, usually written to praise and express sorrow for someone who is dead</i> |
| ** annunciation | <i>announcement</i> |

Text 5 — Blog entry

At the moment, my life is a symphony composed of three distinct movements: 'a lot of people', 'a few people', and 'almost no one'. Each of them lasts about four months of the year; and although there is often a little of each during one particular month, they never get confused. 'A lot of people' is when I'm in touch with the public, with publishers and journalists. 'A few people' happens when I go back to Brazil, meet up with old friends, stroll along Copacabana beach, go to the occasional social event, but mostly stay at home.

What I want to do today, though, is to talk a little about the 'almost no one' movement. Right now, night has fallen on the two hundred inhabitants of this Pyrenean village, where, a short while ago, I bought a converted mill. I live entirely in the present moment, and I transform myself just as the countryside does around me.

At the moment, I'm not much interested in what's going on in Iraq or in Afghanistan: like anyone else living in the country, the most important news is the weather forecast. Everyone who lives in the small village knows whether it is going to rain, whether it will be cold or windy, since this directly affects their lives, their plans, their harvests. I see a farmer working in his field. We wish each other 'Good morning', discuss the likely weather, and then go on with what we were doing.

I come back, look in the letterbox, and there's the local newspaper: a dance in the neighbouring village, a lecture in a bar last night, the fire brigade was called out because a litter bin was set on fire. The subject agitating the region at the moment is a group thought to be responsible for cutting down a line of plane trees along a country road because they blame the trees for the death of a motorcyclist. This news takes up a whole page, and there are several days' worth of articles about the 'secret cell' that wants to avenge the boy's death by destroying the trees.

I lie down by the stream that runs past the mill and look up at the cloudless sky. Next, I practise kyudo, a form of meditation through archery, and this takes up another hour of my day. I have a light meal and then, in one of the other rooms in the old building, I suddenly notice a strange object, with a screen and a keyboard, connected to the internet. I know that the moment I press a button on that machine, the world will come to meet me.

I resist as long as I can, but the moment arrives, my finger presses the on-switch, and here I am again connected with the other world: Brazilian newspapers, books, interviews to be given, news about Iraq, about Afghanistan, requests, a note that my plane ticket will arrive tomorrow, decisions to be postponed, decisions to be taken. I work for several hours, because that is my choice, knowing I have duties and responsibilities. But during the 'almost no one' movement, everything on the computer screen seems very far from the other movements – 'a lot of people' and 'a few people'.

The sun is setting. I switch the computer off again, and the world goes back to being the countryside, the smell of grass, the lowing of cattle, the voice of the shepherd bringing his sheep back to the pen beside the mill.

I ask myself how I can exist in two such different worlds in one day. I have no answer, but I know that it gives me a great deal of pleasure.

PAUL COELHO
A Day at the Mill

2024 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE TRIAL EXAMINATION

English Advanced

Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

General Instructions

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 1 hour and 30 minutes
- Write using black pen
- A Stimulus Booklet is provided
- Write your student number/name on each page

Total marks: 40

Section I – 20 marks (pages 2–7)

- Attempt Questions 1–5
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 20 marks (pages 8–10)

- Attempt Question 6
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

This paper MUST NOT be removed from the examination room

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Section I

20 marks

Attempt Questions 1–5

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Read the texts on pages 2–7 of the Stimulus Booklet carefully and then answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Your answers will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
- analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts

Question 1 (3 marks)

Text 1 — Image

How does the image reveal the importance of human relationships?

The image reveals....

If you need additional space to answer Question 1 use the lines below.

Question 2 (3 marks)

Text 2 — Poem

How does Sophia Thakur challenge us to value quiet moments?

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If you need additional space to answer Question 2 use the lines below.

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STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Question 3 (5 marks)

Text 2 — Poem and Text 3 — Online essay

Compare how Text 2 and Text 3 represent ideas about our reliance on technology.

[illegible]

If you need additional space to answer Question 3 use the lines below.

[illegible]

Section I (continued)

Attempt Questions 4–5

Answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Question 4 (3 marks)

Text 4 — Nonfiction extract

How does David Whyte reveal the role of regret in our lives?

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If you need additional space to answer Question 4 use the lines below.

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STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Question 5 (6 marks)

Text 5 — Blog entry

Analyse how Paul Coelho considers both individual and collective experiences.

[illegible]

Question 5 continues on page 7

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Question 5 (continued)

If you need additional space to answer Question 5 use the lines below.

[illegible]

End of Question 5

Section II

20 marks

Attempt Question 6

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on a separate page or writing booklet, if provided.

Your answers will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
 - organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context
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Question 6 (20 marks)

To what extent are the qualities of ONE or TWO key characters in your prescribed text shaped by their experiences?

In your answer, make detailed reference to your prescribed text.

If your prescribed text is poetry, you must refer to at least TWO poems.

The prescribed texts are listed on pages 9 and 10.

NSW INDEPENDENT TRIAL EXAMS – 2024
ENGLISH (ADVANCED) PAPER 1 TRIAL HSC EXAMINATION
MARKING GUIDELINES

Note: Answer suggestions throughout these marking guidelines should not be seen as exhaustive or prescriptive. Please award marks based on student responses (which may not be listed here) but are supported by sound textual references.

Section I

20 marks

Attempt Questions 1–5

Allow about 40 minutes for this section

Read the texts on pages 2–7 of the Stimulus Booklet carefully and then answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Your answers will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
-

Question 1 (3 marks)

Text 1 — Image

How does the image reveal the importance of human relationships? (3 marks)

Criteria	Marks
• Explains clearly how the image reveals the importance of human relationships	3
• Explains how the image reveals the importance of human relationships	2
• Describes aspects of the text	1

Suggested answers may include:

(Note: these are only suggestions and students should be rewarded for other responses they identify and support from the text.)

- Welcoming gestures shown between the people in the image
- The symbolism of the shared experience of eating shown at the top of the image
- The eyeline of the people engages only with each other and not the settings and possessions shown in the image
- The vector line that establishes the ascension of the female character to the pinnacle where she will engage with others

Question 2 (3 marks)

Text 2 — Poem

How does Sophia Thakur challenge us to value quiet moments? (3 marks)

Criteria	Marks
• Explains clearly how the poet challenges us to value quiet moments	3
• Explains how the poet challenges us to value quiet moments	2
• Describes aspects of the text	1

Suggested answers may include:

(Note: these are only suggestions and students should be rewarded for other responses they identify and support from the text.)

- Rhetorical questions in second stanza around the peace and/or busyness of life.
- The imperative statements, “Be with yourself for a moment. / Be yourself for a moment.”
- Allusion to “airplane mode” suggesting the need to switch off and remove oneself from distractions.
- Sibilance in first stanza to create the tension and inability to surrender to silence.

Question 3 (5 marks)

Text 2 — Poem and Text 3 — Online essay

Compare how Text 2 and Text 3 represent ideas about our reliance on technology. (5 marks)

Criteria	Marks
• Skilfully compares how both texts represent ideas about our reliance on technology using detailed, well-chosen supporting evidence	5
• Compares how both texts represent ideas about our reliance on technology using supporting evidence	4
• Basic comparison of how both texts represent ideas about our reliance on technology using some supporting evidence	3
• Describes aspects of both texts	2
• Composes a response	1

Suggested comparisons may include:

(Note: these are only suggestions and students should be rewarded for other responses they identify and support from the text.)

- The challenge to step away from technology in the poem versus the suggestion we pay closer attention to the consequences of our use of technology in the essay.
- The poem prizes our personal health and status over technology versus the acceptance that technology is inherently part of our experience in the blog.
- The personal cost of our use of technology to one’s sense of well-being established in the poem versus the greater objectivity of the blog in suggesting a balanced and informed approach to our use of technology.
- The poem expresses sentiments about technology and our wellbeing, whereas the blog expresses a more factual and researched examination of our experience of using technology.

Question 4 (3 marks)

Text 4 — Non-fiction extract

How does David Whyte reveal the role of regret in our lives? (3 marks)

Criteria	Marks
• Explains clearly how David Whyte reveals the role of regret in our lives	3
• Explains how David Whyte reveals the role of regret in our lives	2
• Describes aspects of the text	1

Suggested answers may include:

(Note: these are only suggestions and students should be rewarded for other responses they identify and support from the text.)

- Examples from Paragraph One could support the idea that we don't readily express regrets as they indicate our fallibility, loss of control, our history/backstory, and/or sins.
- Examples from Paragraph Two could support notions that regret is not the experience of the young who are yet to acquire regrets.
- Examples from Paragraph Three could support ideas that regrets give us new possibilities and the chance to live better futures.

Question 5 (6 marks)

Text 5 — Blog entry

Analyse how Paul Coelho considers both individual and collective experiences. (6 marks)

Criteria	Marks
• Skilfully analyses how Paul Coelho considers both individual and collective experiences using detailed, well-chosen supporting evidence	6
• Analyses how Paul Coelho considers both individual and collective experiences using supporting evidence	4–5
• Explains how Paul Coelho considers individual and/or collective experiences using some supporting evidence	3
• Describes aspects of the text	2
• Composes a response	1

Suggested answers may include:

(Note: these are only suggestions and students should be rewarded for other responses they identify and support from the text.)

- Individual experiences are largely suggested through the epithets “almost no one” and/or “a few people”, whereas collective experiences are suggested through the epithet “a lot of people”.
- Anecdotes of Coelho’s daily experiences of solitude when he is at his mill home and/or in his small village.
- The accumulation of images that provide insight into the gentle and quiet nature of Coelho’s days in his home and village.
- The juxtaposition of larger world news events, “what’s going on in Iraq or in Afghanistan”, with the smaller and parochial news events of the local village (Paragraph 5).
- The juxtaposition of Coelho’s slow and deliberate day with the high-speed connection to the internet (Paragraph 6).
- The idiom, “the world will come to meet me” suggests a return to collective experiences and engagement.
- The absolute phrases in Paragraph 7 that establish the ‘other world’ of fast-paced demands that draw Coelho back into the larger collective world.

Section II

Question 6 (20 marks)

Your answers will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
 - organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context
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Question 6 (20 marks)

To what extent are the qualities of ONE or TWO key characters in your prescribed text shaped by their experiences?

In your answer, make detailed reference to your prescribed text.

If your prescribed text is poetry, you must refer to at least TWO poems.

The prescribed texts for Section II are:

- Prose Fiction**
- Anthony Doerr, *All the Light We Cannot See*
 - Amanda Lohrey, *Vertigo*
 - George Orwell, *Nineteen Eighty-Four*
 - Favel Parrett, *Past the Shallows*

- Poetry**
- Rosemary Dobson, *Rosemary Dobson Collected*

The prescribed poems are:

- * *Young Girl at a Window*
- * *Over the Hill*
- * *Summer's End*
- * *The Conversation*
- * *Cock Crow*
- * *Amy Caroline*
- * *Canberra Morning*

- Kenneth Slessor, *Selected Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

- * *Wild Grapes*
- * *Gulliver*
- * *Out of Time*
- * *Vesper-Song of the Reverend Samuel Marsden*
- * *William Street*
- * *Beach Burial*

Question 6 continues on the next page

Question 6 (continued)

Criteria	Marks
- Evaluates skilfully and perceptively the extent to which the qualities of ONE or TWO key characters in the prescribed text are shaped by their experiences - Presents an insightful response supported by well-chosen textual references from the prescribed text - Writes a coherent and sustained response using language appropriate for audience, purpose and context	17–20
- Evaluates effectively the extent to which the qualities of ONE or TWO key characters in the prescribed text are shaped by their experiences - Presents a thoughtful response supported by relevant textual references from the prescribed text - Writes an organised response using language appropriate for audience, purpose and context	13–16
- Explains the extent to which the qualities of ONE or TWO key characters in the prescribed text are shaped by their experiences - Presents a response supported by some textual references from the prescribed - Writes a response using variable control of language appropriate for audience and purpose	9–12
- Expresses limited understanding of how human qualities are represented in the text - Describes aspects of the text - Writes a response with minimal control of language	5–8
- Refers to the prescribed text in a minimal way - Attempts to compose a response	1–4